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Entry 2 Speaking and Listening: Lessons 4 to 13

Ten more two-hour lessons. Lessons 4 to 6 build Tasks 1 and 2, lessons 7 to 9 build Task 3, lessons 10 to 12 build Task 4, and lesson 13 is a full mock.

Lesson 4: Talking about the past

Learners finish able to talk for a minute about something that happened, using the past simple, and to ask and answer *Did you…?* and *What did you…?* questions. Assessors listen for a past tense in Tasks 1 and 2.

Materials: Handout E2-4A, one per learner. Topic cards from the handout cut up, one set per pair. A timer.

Activity 1: Yesterday (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw a line on the board with *yesterday* on the left, *today* in the middle and *tomorrow* on the right. Tell the class five things you did yesterday, pointing left: “I got up at six. I walked to the station. I had a coffee. I taught a class. I watched the news.”
2. Ask what you did. Write the verbs on the board as learners recall them, in two columns: *walked, watched* and *got, had, taught*. Ask what is different. Name the columns *add -ed* and *change the word*.
3. Drill the three sounds of *-ed* with hands on the throat: *walked* and *cooked* end in a t sound; *phoned* and *played* end in a d sound; *wanted* and *visited* add a syllable. Do not teach the rule. Train the ear with six more verbs.
4. Build the list of twelve everyday irregular verbs on the board with the class: *go, have, get, eat, buy, come, see, make, meet, take, do, be*. Say the present; learners call the past.
5. Rub out the past forms one at a time. Point to a verb and a learner; they say a true sentence about yesterday.

Activity 2: Last Saturday (20 minutes)

1. Hand out E2-4A. Learners complete the verb table in section A from memory, then check against the board.
2. Learners complete the gap text in section B alone.
3. Pairs compare, then read the text aloud to each other, a sentence each. Listen for the *-ed* endings.
4. Pairs cover the text and retell the day from the verbs alone.

Activity 3: Did you…? (25 minutes)

1. Board the question: *Did you cook dinner yesterday?* Box *Did* and underline *cook*. Ask why it is not *cooked*. Establish: *did* carries the past, so the verb goes back to its basic form.
2. Drill short answers: *Yes, I did. No, I didn’t.* Then the *wh-* form: *What did you cook? Where did you go? Who did you see?*
3. Learners stand and do the survey in section C. They must find a different person for each line, ask one follow-up question, and write the name and one detail.
4. Feedback: learners report one finding each: “Sara went to the market last week. She bought fish.”

5. Correct on the board the two most common errors you heard, usually *Did you went* and *I go yesterday*.

Activity 4: A one-minute past talk (30 minutes)

1. Remind learners of the talk shape from Lesson 1: start, three things, finish. For a past talk, the three things are in time order.
2. Board the frame from section D: *when, where, who with, what happened, how I felt*.
3. Model a talk on *Last weekend* in about one minute, touching each part of the frame.
4. Learners make five-word notes for the topic *A good day*, one word per part. Two minutes.
5. Pairs: A talks, B times one minute. Swap. Change partners and repeat with a new topic card and no notes.
6. Monitor for verbs slipping into the present. Note examples for the end.

Activity 5: Two questions about the past (20 minutes)

1. Remind learners that after the talk the partner asks two questions. For a past talk, the questions use *did* or *was*.
2. Board four starters: *What did you…? Who did you…? Was it…? Did you like…?*
3. In threes: one speaker, one partner, one observer. The speaker takes a topic card and talks. The partner asks two past questions. The observer counts the past verbs they hear and reports the number.
4. Rotate twice so that everyone speaks.
5. Board five sentences you noted, with errors. The class corrects them. Homework: tell someone at home, in English, about your day.

Handout E2-4A: Talking about the past

Section A. Write the past form.

Now	Past	Now	Past
go		walk	
have		cook	
get		watch	
buy		talk	
meet		play	
eat		visit	
see		phone	
is / are		want	

Section B. Write the verb in the past.

Last Saturday I (1) _____ (get) up late. I (2) _____ (have) breakfast and then I (3) _____ (walk) to the market. I (4) _____ (buy) some vegetables and I (5) _____ (meet) my friend. We (6) _____ (talk) for an hour. In the evening I (7) _____ (cook) dinner and (8) _____ (watch) a film. It (9) _____ (be) a good day.

Section C. Find someone who… Ask: Did you…?

Find someone who…	Name	One more detail
cooked dinner yesterday		
went to a market last week		
watched TV last night		
phoned a friend or family at the weekend		

Find someone who…	Name	One more detail
got up before seven today		
walked to college today		

Section D. My past talk.

Part	My notes (one word)
When?	
Where?	
Who with?	
What happened?	
How did I feel?	

Topic cards (cut up)

Last weekend	A good day	Yesterday evening
My first day at this college	A celebration or festival	A meal I enjoyed

Answer key, Lesson 4

- **Section A:** went, had, got, bought, met, ate, saw, was / were; walked, cooked, watched, talked, played, visited, phoned, wanted.
- **Section B:** 1 got, 2 had, 3 walked, 4 bought, 5 met, 6 talked, 7 cooked, 8 watched, 9 was.

Lesson 5: Plans and the future

Learners finish able to talk about plans with *going to*, say what they would like to do and why, and move between past, present and future in one conversation. Assessors listen for a range of tenses at Entry 2.

Materials: Handout E2-5A, one per learner. Twelve time cards for Activity 5, one set per group of three: *yesterday, last week, last night, two days ago, every day, on Mondays, usually, at the weekend, tomorrow, next week, tonight, next year*.

Activity 1: My week (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw a seven-day diary on the board starting from today. Write one plan in three of the days in note form: *dentist, friend, cinema*.
2. Say your plans in full: “On Tuesday I’m going to see the dentist.” Ask what words you used. Board the pattern in boxes: *I’m / going to / verb*.
3. Drill with the three plans. Then let learners hear the natural, fast form, and tell them they will hear it from the assessor but should say the full form themselves.
4. Ask about the empty days: “What am I going to do on Wednesday?” Answer: “Nothing. I’m not going to go out. I’m going to stay at home.” Board the negative.
5. Board the questions: *What are you going to do on…? Are you going to…?* with short answers *Yes, I am. No, I’m not.* Drill in open pairs across the room.

Activity 2: Your week (20 minutes)

1. Hand out E2-5A. Learners fill the diary in section A with real plans in note form. Tell them that ordinary plans are fine: shopping, class, cooking, phoning someone. They need at least four.
2. Pairs ask each other about each day and write the partner’s plans in the second row.
3. Change partners. Learners now tell the new partner about the first partner’s week: “On Friday Ali is going to cook for his friends.”
4. Take one report from each pair. Correct *is going to* and *are going to* on the board.

Activity 3: I'd like to (20 minutes)

1. Write on the board: *I'm going to visit my friend* and *I'd like to visit Scotland*. Ask which one is a plan and which one is a wish. Establish: *going to* for a plan that is decided; *I'd like to* for something you hope for.
2. Drill *I'd like to* with the contracted sound.
3. Give three sentence starters and ask learners to finish them aloud, with *because*: "One day I'd like to learn…" "Next year I'd like to…" "In London I'd like to see…"
4. Learners write three true sentences in section B, then tell a partner. The partner asks "Why?" each time.

Activity 4: A talk about plans (30 minutes)

1. Board the frame from section C: *This weekend I'm going to… After that I'm going to… I'm not going to… One day I'd like to… because…*
2. Model a talk on *My plans for the weekend* for about a minute.
3. Learners make notes, single words only, for two minutes.
4. Pairs: A talks for one minute, B asks two questions with *going to*. Swap.
5. New partners, new topic: *My plans for next year*. No notes this time.
6. Two volunteers give their talk to the class. The class asks questions.

Activity 5: Three tenses (25 minutes)

1. Learners complete section D alone: sort the time words, then choose the correct verb form. Check as a class.
2. Groups of three with the time cards face down. A learner turns over a card and says a true sentence with that time. The next learner asks a question about it. Then the next learner takes a card.
3. After ten minutes, raise the challenge: the speaker takes two cards and must link them in one answer, for example *yesterday* and *tomorrow*.
4. Close with a quick mock of Task 1: pairs ask each other one question about the past, one about now and one about the future.

Handout E2-5A: Plans and the future

Section A. My week.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Me							
My partner							

Section B. Write three true sentences.

1. One day I'd like to _____ because _____.
2. Next year I'd like to _____ because _____.
3. In London I'd like to _____ because _____.

Section C. My talk.

- This weekend I'm going to …
- After that I'm going to …
- I'm not going to …
- One day I'd like to … because …

Section D. Write each time word under Past, Now or Future.

yesterday | tomorrow | last week | every day | next week | two days ago | tonight | usually | last night | next year

Past	Now	Future

Circle the correct verb.

1. I **went / am going to go** to the dentist tomorrow.
2. She **cooked / is going to cook** dinner last night.
3. We **visited / are going to visit** my friend next Sunday.
4. They **watched / are going to watch** a film yesterday.
5. I **started / am going to start** a new course next month.

Answer key, Lesson 5

- **Section D sort:** Past: yesterday, last week, two days ago, last night. Now: every day, usually. Future: tomorrow, next week, tonight, next year.
- **Section D verbs:** 1 am going to go. 2 cooked. 3 are going to visit. 4 watched. 5 am going to start.

Lesson 6: Likes, reasons and comparing

Learners finish able to say how much they like something, give a reason, and compare two things. Task 1 asks about likes and dislikes, and the Task 4 discussion needs opinions with reasons.

Materials: Handout E2-6A, one per learner. Choice cards from the handout cut up, one set per group of three. Six signs for the wall: *I love, I really like, I like, I don't mind, I don't like, I hate*.

Activity 1: How much? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Put the six signs along one wall in order, from *I love* to *I hate*. Say each one with feeling and have the class repeat.
2. Call out a topic: "Cooking." Learners walk to the sign that is true for them. Ask three learners to say the full sentence: "I really like cooking." Board the pattern: *like + verb + -ing*.
3. Repeat with eight topics: *shopping, getting up early, travelling by bus, cleaning, walking, watching football, rain, studying English*.
4. While learners are standing in groups, they ask the person next to them "Why?" and answer with one reason.
5. Back at desks, learners put the six phrases in order in section A of the handout. Teach *I don't mind* carefully with a gesture: it is not good and not bad. It is the phrase most learners lack.

Activity 2: Because it's… (20 minutes)

1. Ask why someone likes the market. Collect reasons. Board them as *because it's* plus an adjective: *cheap, fresh, friendly*.
2. Build two banks on the board, positive and negative: *cheap, relaxing, healthy, tasty, interesting, quick* and *boring, noisy, expensive, crowded, tiring, slow*. Drill the stress in *relaxing, expensive, interesting*.
3. Chain drill. You say a topic; the first learner says a sentence with a reason; the next learner agrees or disagrees: "Me too" or "Really? I don't."
4. Pairs tell each other three things they like and three they do not, each with a reason. The partner reports one back to the class.

Activity 3: Comparing (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Hold up two real things, or name two: the bus and the train. Ask which is cheaper, faster, more comfortable. Board the answers: *The bus is cheaper than the train. The train is more comfortable than the bus.*

2. Elicit the pattern: short words add *-er*; long words take *more*; *good* and *bad* change to *better* and *worse*.
3. Learners complete section B of the handout alone and check in pairs.
4. Teach *I prefer … to … because …* Drill with three pairs of things.
5. Pairs make four comparing sentences about London and another place they know. Hear one from each pair.

Activity 4: Which one? (25 minutes)

1. Groups of three with the choice cards face down.
2. A learner turns over a card, for example *tea or coffee*, and asks the group: "Which do you prefer?" Each person answers with *I prefer* and a comparing reason.
3. The learner who asked must then say who they agree with and why.
4. Monitor and note good language as well as errors.
5. Feedback: write three good sentences you heard on the board and say who said them. Then two errors, without names, for the class to correct.

Activity 5: Task 1 with likes and dislikes (25 minutes)

1. Remind learners how Task 1 works: they ask each other, then the assessor asks more.
2. In threes: two candidates and one assessor. Candidates ask each other four questions about likes and dislikes, each answer with a reason.
3. The assessor then asks each candidate one comparing question from section D of the handout.
4. The assessor gives one point of praise and one target. Rotate until everyone has been a candidate.
5. Close: each learner says one sentence with *I don't mind* to their partner.

Handout E2-6A: Likes, reasons and comparing

Section A. Put these in order, from 1 (most positive) to 6 (most negative).

Phrase	Number
I don't mind	
I love	
I hate	
I like	
I really like	
I don't like	

Section B. Write the comparing form.

Word	Comparing form	Word	Comparing form
cheap		expensive	
quiet		relaxing	
big		interesting	
busy		good	
easy		bad	

Section C. Choice cards (cut up).

tea or coffee	bus or train	market or supermarket	cooking at home or eating out
morning or evening classes	summer or winter	city or countryside	phone call or text message

Section D. Assessor's questions.

1. Which is better, shopping at a market or at a supermarket? Why?
2. Which do you prefer, the morning or the evening? Why?
3. Is London more expensive than other places you know? Why?
4. Which is easier for you, speaking English or reading English? Why?

Answer key, Lesson 6

- **Section A:** I love 1, I really like 2, I like 3, I don't mind 4, I don't like 5, I hate 6.
- **Section B:** cheaper, quieter, bigger, busier, easier; more expensive, more relaxing, more interesting, better, worse.

Lesson 7: Describing people

Learners finish able to describe a person in a picture in an organised and polite way: age and build, hair, clothes, what they are doing and how they seem. This prepares Task 3.

Materials: Handout E2-7A, one per learner. Eight printed photos of people, numbered on the back: an older man reading on a bench; a young woman with a pushchair; a market trader serving a customer; two friends laughing in a café; a bus driver; a child in school uniform; a woman in sports clothes running; a family at a table. One extra photo for modelling.

Activity 1: Head to toe (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Show the modelling photo. Ask for any words. Write them on the board in four groups without labels: age and build; hair and face; clothes; feelings. Ask the class to name the groups.
2. Fill gaps in each group. Age and build: *young, middle-aged, elderly, in his twenties, about forty, tall, short, slim*. Hair and face: *long, short, curly, straight, dark, fair, grey, bald, a beard, glasses*. Clothes: *jacket, coat, scarf, jeans, trainers, uniform*. Feelings: *happy, tired, worried, relaxed, bored*.
3. Teach polite choices. *Elderly* or *older* is kinder than *old*. For age, guess with *about*. Avoid comments on weight: describe height and clothes.
4. Board the three verbs that carry a description and the pattern for each: *He is tall. She has long hair. He is wearing a coat.* Drill by pointing to features of the photo.
5. Common error check. Write *She has tall* and *He is a beard* on the board. Learners correct them.
6. Learners sort the words in section A of the handout and check in pairs.

Activity 2: Model description (20 minutes)

1. Learners complete the gap text in section B alone.
2. Check by reading aloud around the class.
3. Ask learners to number the five steps in the margin: who and age; build and hair; clothes; action; how the person seems.
4. Pairs cover the text and rebuild the description from the five steps.

Activity 3: Who is it? (25 minutes)

1. Put all eight photos on the board or wall, numbers showing.
2. Describe one in four sentences without giving the number. Learners write the number. Check.
3. Pairs take turns: one describes a photo, the other names the number. They must use all three verbs: *is, has, is wearing*.
4. Then describe a classmate's clothes only, without the name. The class guesses who. Rule: clothes and colours only, nothing about the body.
5. Board any clothes words learners needed and did not have.

Activity 4: How do they seem? (20 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Point to a photo. Ask: "Is she happy? How do you know?" Board the pattern: *She looks happy because she is smiling. I think he is tired because his eyes are closed.*

2. Drill *looks* plus adjective with five photos.
3. Teach guessing language for when learners are not sure: *I think, maybe, perhaps*. Assessors reward this, because it shows opinion.
4. Pairs choose three photos and say how each person seems and why. Hear several.

Activity 5: One minute on one person (30 minutes)

1. Groups of three: speaker, partner, timekeeper. The speaker takes an unseen photo and has ten seconds to look.
2. The speaker describes the person for up to a minute using the five steps. The partner asks one question at the end.
3. The timekeeper ticks the checklist in section C and gives feedback.
4. Rotate until everyone has described two photos.
5. Whole class: correct five errors you noted. Close by asking for the three verbs and one example of each.

Handout E2-7A: Describing people

Section A. Write each word under the best heading.

curly | tall | jacket | tired | straight | slim | scarf | happy | grey | bald | trainers | worried | elderly | jeans | relaxed | young

Age and build	Hair	Clothes	Feelings

Section B. Complete the description with words from the box.

slim | hair | wearing | reading | looks | bus

This is a picture of a man. He is about forty years old. He is tall and (1) _____. He has short dark (2) _____ and a beard. He is (3) _____ a grey coat and a red scarf. He is (4) _____ a newspaper. He (5) _____ relaxed. I think he is waiting for a (6) _____ because he is standing at a bus stop.

Section C. Timekeeper's checklist.

	Yes	Not yet
Said who the person is and guessed the age		
Described build or hair with is / has		
Described clothes with is wearing		
Said what the person is doing		
Said how the person seems, with a reason		

Answer key, Lesson 7

- **Section A:** Age and build: tall, slim, elderly, young. Hair: curly, straight, grey, bald. Clothes: jacket, scarf, trainers, jeans. Feelings: tired, happy, worried, relaxed.
- **Section B:** 1 slim, 2 hair, 3 wearing, 4 reading, 5 looks, 6 bus.

Lesson 8: Describing places

Learners finish able to describe a place in a picture and a place they know: what is there, where things are, what it is like and what they think of it. This prepares Task 3 and gives material for Task 2 talks about home and neighbourhood.

Materials: Handout E2-8A, one per learner. Six printed photos of places, numbered on the back: a park; a kitchen; a street market; a classroom; a living room; a high street with a bus stop. Plain paper for maps and drawings.

Activity 1: Where is it? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Use the room. Stand next to a learner and say “I’m next to Ali.” Move and say “Now I’m between Ali and Sara.” Continue with *opposite, behind, in front of, near, in the corner*. Learners repeat each one.
2. Give instructions: “Maria, stand behind your chair.” “Yusuf, stand opposite the door.” Then learners instruct each other.
3. Ask questions about the room: “Where is the board? Where is the bin?” Insist on full sentences with a position phrase.
4. Draw a simple street on the board with six buildings, three on each side. Ask position questions. Then rub out the names and ask learners to tell you where to write them back.
5. Learners complete section A of the handout from the street plan, alone, then check in pairs.

Activity 2: My street (25 minutes)

1. Board four patterns with a tick or cross beside each: *There is a park. There are two shops. There isn’t a cinema. There aren’t any trees.* Drill.
2. Learners complete section B of the handout.
3. Each learner draws a simple map of their own street or the area around where they live: five or six places only. Two minutes of drawing, no more.
4. Pairs describe their map to each other without showing it. The partner draws what they hear, then they compare.
5. Hear three learners tell the class one thing their area has and one thing it does not have.

Activity 3: A room (20 minutes)

1. Elicit furniture and objects for a living room and a kitchen. Board about fifteen words: *sofa, armchair, table, shelf, lamp, rug, curtains, cooker, fridge, sink, cupboard, kettle, window, door, picture*.
2. Describe a room yourself in five sentences with position phrases. Learners draw it as you speak. Compare drawings.
3. Pairs sit back to back. A describes a real room they know. B draws it and asks questions: “Where is the table? Is there a window?”
4. Swap. Then compare the drawings and correct each other in English.

Activity 4: What is it like? (20 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Write the question *What is it like?* on the board. Explain that it asks for a description, not about liking.
2. Build a bank of adjectives for places in opposite pairs: *busy and quiet, clean and dirty, modern and old, safe and dangerous, noisy and peaceful, green and grey*.
3. Hold up each place photo. Learners call out two adjectives and you ask “Why?”
4. Board the opinion ending: *I like this place because… I wouldn’t like to live here because…*
5. Pairs choose two photos and give an opinion on each with a reason.

Activity 5: One minute on one place (30 minutes)

1. Board the four steps: *what place it is; what is there and where; what is happening; my opinion*.
2. Model with one photo for about a minute.

3. Groups of three: speaker, partner, timekeeper. The speaker takes an unseen photo, looks for ten seconds and speaks. The partner asks one question. The timekeeper ticks section C.
4. Rotate until everyone has described two places.
5. Class feedback on errors, especially *there is* with plurals. Close: learners tell a partner where three things in the classroom are.

Handout E2-8A: Describing places

Section A. Look at the street plan. Complete the sentences with **next to**, **opposite** or **between**.

Bank	Post office	Café
ROAD	ROAD	ROAD
Park	Library	Chemist

1. The post office is _____ the bank and the café.
2. The bank is _____ the post office.
3. The library is _____ the post office.
4. The café is _____ the chemist.
5. The library is _____ the park and the chemist.

Section B. Write **There is**, **There are**, **There isn't** or **There aren't**.

1. (yes) _____ a park near my house.
2. (yes) _____ two supermarkets.
3. (no) _____ a cinema.
4. (no) _____ any trees in my street.
5. (yes) _____ a bus stop outside.

Section C. Timekeeper's checklist.

	Yes	Not yet
Said what place it is		
Used there is and there are		
Used two position phrases		
Said what is happening		
Gave an opinion with a reason		

Answer key, Lesson 8

- **Section A:** 1 between, 2 next to, 3 opposite, 4 opposite, 5 between.
- **Section B:** 1 There is, 2 There are, 3 There isn't, 4 There aren't, 5 There is.

Lesson 9: Describing things

Learners finish able to describe an object by size, shape, material and use, and to keep talking when they do not know the English word. This prepares Task 3 and is the best protection against silence in the exam.

Materials: Handout E2-9A, one per learner. A cloth bag with eight real objects: keys, a mug, scissors, a phone charger, an umbrella, a torch, a sponge, a wooden spoon. One photo of a kitchen table or desk with many objects on it. Twelve word cards for Activity 3: *kettle, pillow, ladder, toothbrush, wallet, iron, fridge, mirror, towel, suitcase, bin, candle*.

Activity 1: What's in the bag? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Put your hand in the bag, hold one object without showing it, and describe it: "It's small. It's hard. It's made of metal." Learners guess. Show it.
2. Board three headings as they arise: *size, shape, material*. Fill them: *big, small, tiny, huge, long, short; round, square, flat, thin; metal, plastic, wood, glass, paper, cloth*.
3. Drill *It's made of…* with objects around the room. Learners point and say.
4. Invite learners to the front one at a time to feel an object in the bag and describe it for the class to guess. Help with words as needed and add them to the board.
5. Learners sort the words in section A of the handout and check in pairs.

Activity 2: What is it for? (20 minutes)

1. Hold up the scissors. Ask: "What is it for?" Board two ways to answer: *It's for cutting paper. You use it to cut paper.*
2. Drill both patterns with the eight objects from the bag.
3. Learners match the objects and uses in section B of the handout, then say each one as a full sentence to a partner.
4. Pairs read the four mystery descriptions in section C and write the object. Check as a class.

Activity 3: I don't know the word (30 minutes, teacher-led then groups)

1. Tell learners that in the exam they may see something in a picture and not know its name. Stopping is the only wrong answer. Describing it is a good answer.
2. Board four rescue phrases and drill them: *I don't know the word in English, but… It's a thing for… It's like a… You find it in a…*
3. Model with a word they will not know, such as a colander: "I don't know the word, but it's a thing for washing rice or vegetables. It's round and made of metal. It has small holes. You find it in a kitchen."
4. Groups of four with the twelve word cards face down. A learner takes a card and describes the object without saying the word. The group guesses. Learners who do not know the word on their card may show you and ask quietly.
5. After ten minutes, change the rule: the describer must use at least one rescue phrase.
6. Feedback: praise the best descriptions you heard and repeat them for the class.

Activity 4: Something important to me (20 minutes)

1. Show an object of your own, such as your watch or a pen, and talk about it for a minute: what it looks like, where you got it, why it matters.
2. Learners choose something they have with them or at home. They make four notes: *what it is; what it looks like; where it is from; why I like it*.
3. Pairs tell each other. The listener asks two questions.
4. Two volunteers speak to the class.

Activity 5: A picture full of things (25 minutes)

1. Show the photo of the table with many objects. Learners look for 30 seconds, then you hide it. In pairs they list everything they remember.
2. Show it again. Model a one-minute description: the whole picture, then three objects with size, material and use, then an opinion about whose table it might be.
3. Pairs take turns to describe the same photo for a minute each, choosing different objects.
4. The listener ticks section D of the handout.
5. Close: each learner describes one object in the room for the class to guess, in two sentences.

Handout E2-9A: Describing things

Section A. Write each word under Size, Shape or Material.

metal | round | tiny | plastic | square | huge | wooden | long | glass | flat | paper | small

Size	Shape	Material

Section B. Match the object to its use. Write the letter.

Object	Letter		It's for…
1. kettle			A. seeing in the dark
2. scissors			B. washing dishes
3. umbrella			C. boiling water
4. charger			D. keeping dry in the rain
5. torch			E. cutting paper
6. sponge			F. giving power to a phone

Section C. What is it?

1. It's small and made of metal. You use it to open a door. _____
2. It's long and thin and made of plastic. You use it to clean your teeth. _____
3. It's flat and made of glass and metal. You use it to call people and send messages. _____
4. It's round. It has numbers. You use it to tell the time. _____

Rescue phrases

- I don't know the word in English, but …
- It's a thing for …
- It's like a …
- You find it in a …

Section D. Listener's checklist.

	Yes	Not yet
Started with the whole picture		
Described three things		
Said what something is made of		
Said what something is for		
Kept talking when a word was missing		

Answer key, Lesson 9

- **Section A:** Size: tiny, huge, small. Shape: round, square, long, flat. Material: metal, plastic, wooden, glass, paper.
- **Section B:** 1 C, 2 E, 3 D, 4 F, 5 A, 6 B.

- **Section C:** 1 a key. 2 a toothbrush. 3 a phone. 4 a clock or a watch.

Lesson 10: Listening to messages and announcements

Learners finish able to catch numbers, times and days in a short message, and to notice when a speaker corrects or changes a detail. This prepares the monologues in Task 4.

Materials: Handout E2-10A, one per learner. The teacher's scripts below. Read each script at natural speed, twice, as the assessor's recording would play.

Activity 1: Thirteen or thirty? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write *13* and *30* on the board. Say one of them. Learners point left or right. Repeat fast with *14 and 40, 15 and 50, 16 and 60, 17 and 70*.
2. Show the difference: *thirTEEN* has the stress at the end and a long sound; *THIRty* has the stress at the start. Drill in pairs: one says a number, the other writes it.
3. Times. Draw a clock. Elicit the two ways to say each time: *two forty-five* and *quarter to three*; *nine thirty* and *half past nine*. Recordings use both.
4. Learners do section A of the handout as you read the numbers and times aloud once each: *thirty; fifteen; forty; seventeen; ten to three; half past six*.
5. Learners do section B alone, writing times in figures. Check on the board.

Activity 2: Listen for the change (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Say: "The class is in Room 12. Sorry, not Room 12. Room 20." Ask which room. Ask which word warned them. Board the warning words: *not, sorry, now, instead, changed, cancelled, delayed*.
2. Explain that recordings often give a wrong detail first. The second detail is usually the answer.
3. Read six short sentences with a change in each. Learners write only the final detail: "The bus leaves at nine, sorry, at ten." "We meet on Monday. No, the meeting has changed to Tuesday." "It costs five pounds. Today it is only three." "Go to desk A. Desk A is closed, so use desk C instead." "The film starts at seven thirty, not seven." "Platform 1 is closed. The train now leaves from platform 6."
4. Check. Ask which warning word they heard each time.

Activity 3: Two messages (30 minutes)

1. Before each script, read the questions in section C aloud together. Learners say what kind of answer each needs: yes or no, a number, a day, a time.
2. Read Script A. First time: no writing, then answer the yes/no question together aloud with a short answer. Second time: learners write the details.
3. Check. Ask what was said about platform 2. It was the old platform.
4. Repeat with Script B. This one has a day, a date, a time and a phone number. Read the phone number in pairs of digits, as a real message would.
5. Pairs compare and say their answers as full sentences: "The new appointment is on Thursday at quarter to three."

Activity 4: Exam mode (20 minutes)

1. Explain that in the exam nothing is written down. The assessor asks, and learners answer aloud.
2. Put learners in pairs, A and B. Read Script C twice. Ask all the As the yes/no question; they whisper the answer to their partner. Ask all the Bs the detail question; they whisper. Then confirm aloud.
3. Read Script D twice. Swap: Bs take the yes/no question, As the detail.
4. Ask two or three pairs to give their answers aloud to the class as full sentences.

Activity 5: Write an announcement (25 minutes)

1. Pairs write a short announcement of three or four sentences for a place they choose: a station, a shop, a college or a surgery. It must include one time or number, and one change with a warning word.
2. They write one yes/no question and one detail question for it.
3. Each pair reads their announcement to another pair twice and asks the questions.
4. Two pairs perform for the class. Close: learners tell a partner two warning words to listen for.

Teacher's scripts

Script A (station). Attention please. The ten fifteen train to Cambridge is delayed by twenty minutes. It will now leave from platform 4, not platform 2. We are sorry for the delay.

- Yes/no: Is the train on time? (No, it isn't.)
- Detail: Which platform does it leave from? (Platform 4.) How late is it? (Twenty minutes.)

Script B (voicemail). Hello, this is Brook Road Dental Practice with a message for Mrs Amina Khalid. Your appointment on Monday is cancelled because the dentist is away. Your new appointment is on Thursday the fifteenth at quarter to three. If you cannot come, please call us on 020 7946 0131. Thank you.

- Yes/no: Is the appointment still on Monday? (No, it isn't.)
- Detail: What day is the new appointment? (Thursday.) What time? (Quarter to three.) What is the phone number? (020 7946 0131.)

Script C (supermarket). Good morning, shoppers. Today only, all fresh bread is half price. You can find it in aisle seven, next to the fruit. The store closes at eight o'clock tonight.

- Yes/no: Is the bread cheaper today? (Yes, it is.)
- Detail: Which aisle is the bread in? (Aisle seven.)

Script D (college). This is a message for all students. The college is closed next Monday for a staff training day. Classes start again on Tuesday at the normal time. The library is open on Monday from ten until four.

- Yes/no: Are there classes next Monday? (No, there aren't.)
- Detail: When is the library open on Monday? (From ten until four.)

Handout E2-10A: Messages and announcements

Section A. Listen. Circle what you hear.

1. 13 / 30
2. 15 / 50
3. 14 / 40
4. 17 / 70
5. 2.10 / 2.50
6. 6.30 / 6.13

Section B. Write the time in numbers.

Words	Numbers
quarter past three	
half past nine	
quarter to three	
ten to eight	
twenty past eleven	

Section C. Listen and answer.

	Question	Answer
Message 1	Is the train on time?	
	Which platform does it leave from?	
	How late is it?	
Message 2	Is the appointment still on Monday?	
	What day is the new appointment?	
	What time is it?	
	What is the phone number?	

Warning words: not | sorry | now | instead | changed | cancelled | delayed

Answer key, Lesson 10

- **Section A:** 1 30. 2 15. 3 40. 4 17. 5 2.50. 6 6.30.
- **Section B:** 3.15, 9.30, 2.45, 7.50, 11.20.
- **Section C:** as shown under the scripts.

Lesson 11: Listening to everyday conversations

Learners finish able to work out where a conversation happens and who is speaking, follow a change of plan, and answer a yes/no and a detail question about a short dialogue. This prepares the dialogues in Task 4.

Materials: Handout E2-11A, one per learner. The teacher's scripts below. If a colleague or a strong learner can read the second voice, use them. If not, turn your body and change your voice for each speaker.

Activity 1: Where are they? (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Read six opening lines, one at a time. After each, learners say where the speakers are and who they are: "Next, please. Are you paying by card?" "Take a seat. The doctor will call you." "Is this seat free?" "Have you got your student card?" "Eat in or take away?" "Return or single?"
2. For each, ask which words gave the answer. Board them under place names: *shop, surgery, bus or train, college, café, station*.
3. Explain why this matters: once you know the place, you can guess what people will say, and the listening becomes easier.
4. Pairs think of one more typical line for each place. Hear several and let the class guess the place.

Activity 2: Change of plan (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Recall the warning words from Lesson 10. In conversations the change is softer. Board the phrases: *I'd love to, but… Can we make it…? Actually… I'm sorry, we've run out of… What about…?*
2. Read this short exchange twice: "Shall we meet at two?" "Can we make it three? I need to cook first." "Three is fine." Ask what time they will meet and how learners know. The last agreed detail is the answer.
3. Give four more mini exchanges orally and ask for the final plan each time. Vary the detail: a day, a place, a food, a price.
4. Drill the phrases. Learners will need them in their own speaking too.

Activity 3: Two conversations (30 minutes)

1. Read the questions for Conversation 1 in section A of the handout together. Learners predict the place.
2. Read Script A twice. First time for the yes/no question, answered aloud together. Second time for the details, written on the handout.
3. Check. Ask how many tablets the customer can take in one day. This needs careful listening for *eight*.
4. Repeat with Script B. Ask why the answer to the time question is three and not two.
5. Pairs compare and then answer aloud in full sentences.

Activity 4: Exam mode (20 minutes)

1. Pairs, A and B. Read Script C twice. As answer the yes/no question in a whisper to their partner; Bs answer the detail question. Confirm aloud.
2. Read Script D twice. Swap roles.
3. Ask the class what the trap was in Script D. The customer asked for cheese and did not get it.
4. Three pairs give their answers to the class as full sentences.

Activity 5: Act it and discuss it (30 minutes)

1. Give out section B of the handout: the four conversations as prompts only. Pairs choose one and rebuild it from memory, changing any details they like.
2. Pairs perform for another pair, who answer one yes/no question and one detail question set by the performers.
3. Then the four learners discuss the matching question from section C for two minutes, as in the discussion at the end of Task 4.
4. Two groups perform for the class.
5. Close: learners tell a partner the three things to listen for in a conversation: the place, the people, the final detail.

Teacher's scripts

Script A (pharmacy).

- A: Hello. Can I help?
- B: Yes. I've got a bad headache. Have you got anything for it?
- A: Have you taken anything today?
- B: No, nothing.
- A: These tablets are good. Take two now and two more after four hours. Don't take more than eight in one day.
- B: OK. How much are they?
- A: One pound twenty.
- Yes/no: Has the customer got a stomach ache? (No, she hasn't. She has a headache.)
- Detail: How many tablets does she take now? (Two.) How much are they? (One pound twenty.)

Script B (two friends).

- A: Do you want to go to the park on Sunday?
- B: I'd love to, but I'm busy in the morning.
- A: What about the afternoon? Two o'clock?
- B: Can we make it three? I need to cook lunch first.
- A: Three is fine. Shall we meet at the gate?
- B: Yes. I'll bring some tea.
- Yes/no: Are they going to meet in the morning? (No, they aren't.)
- Detail: What time are they going to meet? (Three o'clock.) Where? (At the gate.)

Script C (college reception).

- A: Good morning. I'd like to join an English class.
- B: Of course. Have you studied here before?
- A: No, this is my first time.
- B: OK. You need to do a short test first. We have tests on Wednesday at ten or Friday at one.
- A: Wednesday, please.
- B: Fine. Please bring some ID and come to Room 3.
- Yes/no: Has the student studied at the college before? (No, he hasn't.)
- Detail: Which day is his test? (Wednesday.)

Script D (café).

- A: What would you like?
- B: A cheese sandwich and a tea, please.
- A: I'm sorry, we've run out of cheese. We've got egg or chicken.
- B: Egg, please.
- A: Eat in or take away?
- B: Take away.
- A: That's four pounds fifty.
- Yes/no: Does the customer get a cheese sandwich? (No, she doesn't.)
- Detail: How much does she pay? (Four pounds fifty.)

Handout E2-11A: Everyday conversations

Section A. Listen and answer.

	Question	Answer
Conversation 1	Has the customer got a stomach ache?	
	How many tablets does she take now?	
	How much are they?	
Conversation 2	Are they going to meet in the morning?	
	What time are they going to meet?	
	Where are they going to meet?	

Section B. Rebuild a conversation from the prompts.

Place	Prompts
Pharmacy	problem / taken anything? / how many? / price
Two friends	invite / busy / new time / place
College	join a class / studied before? / test day / what to bring
Café	order / sorry, run out / new choice / price

Section C. Discussion questions.

1. What do you do when you feel ill?

2. Where do you like to meet friends? Why?
3. Was it easy to join this college? What happened?
4. Do you prefer to eat at home or in a café? Why?

Answer key, Lesson 11

- **Section A:** as shown under Scripts A and B.

Lesson 12: Discussion skills

Learners finish able to give an opinion with a reason, agree and disagree politely, bring their partner into the conversation and check when they have not understood. This prepares the discussion that ends Task 4.

Materials: Handout E2-12A, one per learner. Statement cards from the handout cut up, one set per group of three. Three counters, coins or paper clips per learner.

Activity 1: Five jobs in a discussion (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write a statement on the board: *London is a good place to live.* Ask two strong learners what they think. Let them talk for a minute while the class listens.
2. Ask the class what the two speakers did. Draw out five jobs and board them as headings: *give an opinion; agree; disagree; ask your partner; check you understand*.
3. Elicit or teach two or three phrases under each. Opinion: *I think, In my opinion*. Agree: *I agree, That's true*. Disagree: *I'm not sure about that, I see what you mean, but*. Ask: *What about you? Do you agree?* Check: *Sorry, can you say that again? Do you mean…?*
4. Drill each phrase with natural intonation. Spend longest on polite disagreement. *I see what you mean, but* sounds friendly; a flat *No* does not.
5. Learners sort the ten phrases in section A of the handout, then check in pairs.

Activity 2: Keep it going (20 minutes)

1. Demonstrate a dead conversation with a learner: you give an opinion and stop. Silence. Ask the class what was missing. Answer: a question to the partner.
2. Board the rule: *opinion + reason + question*. Model: "I think markets are better because the food is fresh. What do you think?"
3. Add small reactions that show listening: *Really? Me too. That's interesting.* Drill them.
4. Pairs get a topic from you every 90 seconds and must keep talking until you call the next one: *food, buses, weather, phones, weekends*. The rule is that nobody speaks twice in a row.
5. Ask which pairs never had a silence and what they did.

Activity 3: Sorry, what does that mean? (20 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Tell learners that asking for help in the exam is allowed and shows good communication.
2. Board three situations and a phrase for each: you did not hear (*Sorry, can you say that again, please?*); you heard but did not understand a word (*Sorry, what does … mean?*); you want to check (*Do you mean…?*).
3. Speak to individual learners deliberately too fast or with a hard word. They must respond with the right phrase. Then repeat slowly or explain.
4. Pairs do the same to each other with questions from section B: one reads the question too quietly or too fast, the other asks for help, then answers.

Activity 4: Three counters (30 minutes)

1. Groups of three with the statement cards face down and three counters each.
2. A learner turns over a statement and reads it. The group discusses it for three minutes.
3. Each time a learner gives an opinion with a reason, asks a partner a question, or agrees or disagrees with a phrase from the board, they put one counter in the middle. The aim is to use all three counters before time is up.
4. Call time, collect counters back, and move to the next card. Do four rounds.
5. Monitor and note good examples of polite disagreement to share.

Activity 5: Discussion with the assessor (25 minutes)

1. Explain the exam: the assessor asks a question to both learners. They should answer the assessor and also talk to each other.
2. Fishbowl. Two volunteers sit at the front with you as assessor. Ask two questions from section B. The class uses the tally in section C to count what each speaker does.
3. Feedback from the tallies: which of the five jobs did the speakers do most and least?
4. Groups of three repeat the task, taking turns as assessor.
5. Close: each learner tells a partner the phrase they will use to disagree politely.

Handout E2-12A: Discussion skills

Section A. Write each phrase under the right job.

I think … | What about you? | I agree. | I'm not sure about that. | In my opinion … | Do you agree? | That's true. | I see what you mean, but … | Sorry, can you say that again? | Do you mean …?

Give an opinion	Agree	Disagree	Ask your partner	Check

Section B. Assessor's questions.

1. Is it better to live in a city or a small town? Why?
2. Is it easy to make friends in London? Why?
3. What is the best way to learn English outside the classroom?
4. Do people spend too much time on their phones?
5. Is it important to eat together as a family or with friends?
6. What would make your area better?

Statement cards (cut up)

Markets are better than supermarkets.	Children should not have phones.	Everyone should learn to cook.
Buses are better than trains.	It is better to get up early.	Winter is worse than summer.

Section C. Tally. Make a mark each time you hear it.

	Speaker A	Speaker B
Gave an opinion with a reason		
Agreed or disagreed with a phrase		
Asked the partner a question		
Asked for help or checked		

Answer key, Lesson 12

- **Section A:** Opinion: I think, In my opinion. Agree: I agree, That's true. Disagree: I'm not sure about that, I see what you mean, but. Ask your partner: What about you? Do you agree? Check: Sorry, can you say that again? Do you mean?

Lesson 13: Full mock exam

Every learner sits all four tasks as a candidate once, in a pair, with a classmate reading the assessor's card and another observing. They leave with written feedback on each task.

Materials: Handout E2-13A, the assessor's cards, two copies per group of four. Handout E2-13B, the observer's sheet, one per learner. The photos from Lessons 7, 8 and 9, shuffled, four per group. A timer per group, or one on the board.

Activity 1: Briefing (15 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Tell the class what the real exam is like: about 25 minutes, in pairs, with one assessor, four tasks in a fixed order. Today's version is shorter so that everyone has a turn.
2. Elicit the four tasks and one tip for each. Board them: *Task 1, full questions and answer plus one more thing. Task 2, start, three things, finish. Task 3, whole picture, parts, opinion. Task 4, yes or no first, then the detail, then talk to each other.*
3. Drill the three rescue phrases: *Sorry, can you say that again, please? Sorry, what does … mean? I don't know the word, but…*
4. Put learners in groups of four: two candidates, one assessor, one observer. Explain each role. The assessor reads only what is on the card. The observer writes and does not speak.

Activity 2: Mock, round one (35 minutes)

1. Groups use Set A. The assessor follows the card and the times on it. Total: about 16 minutes.
2. For Task 4, the assessor reads each script twice, clearly. Join each group for part of Task 4 if the assessor is not a confident reader, and read the script yourself.
3. The observer completes 13B for both candidates during the mock.
4. After the mock, the observer gives each candidate the sheet and reads out one strength and one target. Allow five minutes.
5. Circulate throughout. Note language errors for Activity 4 and do not interrupt.

Activity 3: Mock, round two (35 minutes)

1. Roles swap: the two candidates become assessor and observer, and the other two become candidates.
2. Groups use Set B, with different photos.
3. Same procedure and timing as round one.
4. If a group finishes early, the four learners discuss the extra question at the bottom of the card.

Activity 4: Feedback and exam day (35 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Each learner reads their observer's sheet and circles the task with the fewest ticks. Take a show of hands for each task to see where the class is weakest.
2. Board eight errors you noted, without names. Pairs correct them. Check together.
3. Reteach the weakest task for ten minutes using the tip on the board and one quick practice round in pairs.
4. Explain exam day in plain terms: bring ID if the college asks for it; arrive early; the assessor is friendly and wants to hear them speak; they may ask for repetition; they should speak to their partner as well as to the assessor.
5. Each learner writes one target on the back of their sheet and tells their partner.

Handout E2-13A: Assessor's cards

Set A

Task	Say this	Time
1	Please ask each other questions about where you live, your free time and what you like. Then: (to each	3 minutes

Task	Say this	Time
	candidate) What did you do last weekend?	
2	(To candidate 1) Please talk about your neighbourhood. (To candidate 2) Please ask two questions. Then swap: (to candidate 2) Please talk about your plans for next weekend.	4 minutes
3	(Give each candidate a photo.) Please describe your picture to your partner.	4 minutes
4	Listen. (Read text 1 twice. Ask candidate 1 the yes/no question and candidate 2 the detail question. Read text 2 twice. Swap.) Then ask both: Do you know your neighbours? Do you prefer shops or buying online? Why?	5 minutes

Set A, text 1. Good morning. Here is the weather for London today. This morning it will be cloudy and cold, with some rain before lunch. This afternoon will be dry and sunny. The temperature will be about twelve degrees. Don't forget your umbrella this morning.

- Yes/no: Will it rain in the afternoon? (No, it won't.)
- Detail: What will the temperature be? (About twelve degrees.)

Set A, text 2.

- A: Hello, I'm your neighbour from number 9. I've got a parcel for you.
- B: Oh, thank you. When did it come?
- A: Yesterday afternoon, about four o'clock. You were out.
- B: Yes, I was at college. It's my new shoes.
- A: Lovely. See you later.
- Yes/no: Did the parcel come this morning? (No, it didn't.)
- Detail: What is in the parcel? (Shoes.)

Set B

Task	Say this	Time
1	Please ask each other questions about your family or friends, food and what you don't like. Then: (to each candidate) What are you going to do after class?	3 minutes
2	(To candidate 1) Please talk about a good day you had. (To candidate 2) Please ask two questions. Then swap: (to candidate 2) Please talk about food you like.	4 minutes
3	(Give each candidate a photo.) Please describe your picture to your partner.	4 minutes

Task	Say this	Time
4	Listen. (Read text 1 twice. Ask candidate 1 the yes/no question and candidate 2 the detail question. Read text 2 twice. Swap.) Then ask both: How do you travel in London? Do you do any exercise?	5 minutes

Set B, text 1. Thank you for calling Eastway Leisure Centre. The swimming pool is open every day from seven in the morning until nine at night. On Saturdays there are swimming lessons for adults at eleven o'clock. A lesson costs six pounds. To book, press one.

- Yes/no: Is the pool open every day? (Yes, it is.)
- Detail: How much is a lesson? (Six pounds.)

Set B, text 2.

- A: Excuse me, does this bus go to the hospital?
- B: No, it doesn't. You need the number twelve.
- A: Oh. Where does that stop?
- B: Across the road, outside the bank.
- A: How often does it come?
- B: Every ten minutes.
- A: Thank you very much.
- Yes/no: Does the first bus go to the hospital? (No, it doesn't.)
- Detail: How often does the number twelve come? (Every ten minutes.)

Extra question for early finishers: What is the best thing and the worst thing about living in London?

Handout E2-13B: Observer's sheet

Candidate: _____ Observer: _____

Task	I heard…	Tick
1	Full questions with do, did or are	
1	Answers with one more thing	
2	A talk with a start, three things and a finish	
2	Two questions for the partner	
2	A past or future sentence	
3	The whole picture, then the parts	
3	There is, there are and position words	
3	An opinion with a reason	
4	A correct yes or no answer	
4	A correct detail	

Task	I heard…	Tick
4	An opinion and a question to the partner	

One strength: _____

One target: _____